

"Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace" increase of his powerful rule in peace, there will be no end. Vast will be his dominion, he will reign on David's throne and over all his righteousness from this time onward and forever.

The zealous love of Lord Sabaoth will do this.

The word of the Lord.

1. Eze Amuru Ohuru.
2. Jesu nwa Oma by Ify Eze

LIGHTING OF CHRISTMAS LIGHT (CHRISTMAS CANDLE / TREE) (Congregational Hymn)

To be conducted by Barr. Maxi Okwu

Silent Night

1. Silent night! holy night!
All is calm all is bright
Round yon virgin mother and child
Holy infant so tender and mild
Sleep in heavenly peace!
Sleep in heavenly peace!

2. Silent night! holy night!
Shepherds quake at the sight
Glories stream from heaven afar
Heavenly hosts sing Alleluia
Christ the Saviour is born!
Christ the Saviour is born!

SEVENTH LESSON:

Luke 2:8-14

By: Mr. Cajetan Onyemaechi
THEME: GLORY TO GOD IN THE HIGHEST

There were shepherds camping in the countryside, taking turns to watch over their flocks by night. Suddenly an angel of the Lord appeared to them, with the Glory of the Lord shining around them. As they were terrified, the angel said to them, "Don't be afraid, I am here to give you good news, great joy for the people. Today a savior has been born to you in David's town; he is the Messiah and the Lord.

3. O Tannenbaum (O Christmas Tree)

Oh Christmas tree, Oh Christmas tree!

Thy leaves are so unchanging
Oh Christmas tree, Oh Christmas tree,

Thy leaves are so unchanging
Not only green when summer's here,
But also when it's cold and drear.

Oh Christmas tree, Oh Christmas tree,

Thy leaves are so unchanging!

Let this be a sign to you, you will find a baby wrapped in swaddling clothes and lying in a manger." Suddenly the angel was surrounded by many more heavenly spirits, praising God and saying, "Glory to God in the highest, and peace on earth, to those whom God loves."

The word of the Lord.

Choir Presentation

1. Adaku Onye Ajo Obi (Song & Drama)
2. Kposhieme

EIGHT LESSON:

Matthew 2:1-11

By: Chief Jude Ogwulu

THEME: THE MAGI VISIT

Now when Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judea in the days of Herod the king, behold, there came wise men from the East Jerusalem, saying, where is He that is born, king of the Jew? For we have seen His star in the east and have come to worship Him.

When Herod the King had heard these things, he was troubled and all Jerusalem with him. And when he gathered all the chief priests and scribes of the people together, he demanded of them where Christ is to be born. And they say unto him, in Bethlehem in the land of Judea, art not the least among the princes of Judea, for out of thee shall come a governor that shall rule my people Israel. Then Herod, when had privately called the wise men, enquired of them diligently what time the star appeared. And hesent them to Bethlehem and said, go and search diligently for the young child, and when you find him, bring me word again that I may come and worship Him also.

When they had heard the king, they departed; and lo, the star which they saw in the east, went before them again till it came and stood over where the young child was. When they saw the star, they rejoiced with exceedingly great joy. And when they came into the house, they saw the young child with Mary his mother and fell down and worshiped Him; and when they had opened their treasures, they presented unto Him gifts; Gold, Frankincense and Myrrh.

The word of the Lord

Choir Presentation:

1. Ogene Ekeresimesi
2. Animal Carol

NINTH LESSON:

Luke 1:26-38

(Gospel) By a Priest

THEME: ANNUNCIATION

In the sixth month, the angel Gabriel was sent from God to a town of Galilee called Nazareth. He was sent to a young virgin, who was betrothed to a man named Joseph of the family of David; and the virgin's name was Mary. The angel came to her and said, "Rejoice, you are full of grace, the Lord is with you." Mary was troubled at these words, wondering what this greeting could mean. But the angel said, "Do not fear, Mary, for God has looked kindly on you. You shall conceive and bear a son, and you shall call him Jesus. He will be great, shall rightly call son of the Most High. Lord God will give Him the kingdom of David his ancestor; He will rule over the people of Jacob forever, and his reign shall have no end." Then Mary said to the angel, "How can this be since I am a virgin?" And the angel said to her, "The Holy Spirit will come upon you and the power of the Most High will overshadow you therefore, the holy child to be born of you shall be called Son of God.

Even your relative Elizabeth is expecting a son in her old age, although she was unable to have a child; and she is now in her sixth month. With God nothing is impossible." Then Mary said, "I am the handmaid of the Lord, let it be done to me as you have said." And the angel left her.

The gospel of the Lord

HOMILY

Choir Presentation:

1. Litany of Blessed Virgin
2. Ekene Maria (Ave Ave Maria)
3. Hallelujah Chorus
4. We wish you a Merry Christmas

CATHOLIC DIOCESE OF AWGU
ST. MARY'S PARISH ACHI

ST. CECILIA CHOIR OF
ST. MARY'S CENTRE STATION

P R E S E N T S

CHRISTMAS CAROL AND NINE LESSONS

27TH DEC 2023, 4PM

@ ST MARY'S PARISH ACHI,
OJI RIVER ENUGU STATE.

Chukwuogho
Gerald Somtochukwu
Choir Master

Mr. Ikekpeazu
Emmanuel Obinna
Choir President

Ogbuehi
Emeka Nwoke
Chairman of the Occasion

HRH Igwe Felix
Chima Achiekwelu,
Eze Ishiala
Royal Father of the Day

Rev. Fr.
Charles Chigbata
Parish Priest / Chief Host

PROGRAMME of the *Event*

Choir candle light procession / Processional hymns	Lighting of Christmas Light (Christmas Candle / Tree) [Show some love to the Choir]
Opening prayer	Lessons / choir presentations 7 to 9
Congregational hymn	Homily (Christmas Message)
Opening Remark / Welcome address	Closing Remark
Lessons / choir presentations 1 to 6	Closing prayer

Choir Candle Light / Processional *Hymns*

Ding Dong

1. Ding-dong! Merrily on high in heaven the bells are ringing. Ding-dong! Verily the sky is riven with angels singing: Gloria, hosanna in excelsis!

2. E'en so, here below, below, let steeple bells be swungen; and i-o, i-o, i-o, by priest and people sungen! Gloria, hosanna in excelsis!

3. Pray you, dutifully prime your matin chime, you ringers; may you beautifully rhyme your evetime song, you singers:

HARK! THE HERALD ANGELS SING

1. Hark! The herald angels sing Glory to the new-born king Peace on earth and mercy mild God and sinners reconciled Joyful all ye nations rise Join the triumph of the skies With angelic host proclaim "Christ is born in Bethlehem" Hark! The herald angels sing "Glory to the new-born king"

2. Hail the heaven-born Prince of Peace! Hail the Sun of Righteousness! Light and life to all He brings Risen with healing in His wings Mild He lays His glory by Born that man no more may die Born to raise the sons of earth Born to give them second birth Hark! The herald angels sing "Glory to the new-born king"

CONGREGATIONAL HYMN

[To be conducted by the Parish Priest Friar Charles Chigbata OFN Cap

1. O come, O come, Emmanuel And ransom captive Israel That mourns in lonely exile here Until the Son of God appear

[Refrain] Rejoice! Rejoice! Emmanuel Shall come to thee, O Israel

2. O come, Thou Dayspring, come and cheer Our spirits by Thine advent here Disperse the gloomy clouds of night And death's dark shadows put to flight. Ref

FIRST LESSON:

Isaiah 40:1-5
By: Dr. Modestus Igboosofulu
THEME: THE LORD WILL COMFORT HIS PEOPLE

Be comforted, my people, be strengthened, says your God. Speak to the heart of Jerusalem, proclaim to her that her time of bondage is at an end, and that her guilt has been paid for, and punishment for all her iniquity. A voice cries, "in the wilderness prepare the way for the Lord. Make straight in the desert a highway for our God.

Every valley will be raised up; every mountain and hill will be laid low. The stumbling blocks shall become level and the rugged places smooth. And the glory of the Lord shall be revealed, and all earth shall see it together, for the mouth of the Lord has spoken it."

The word of the Lord
Choir Presentation:
1. The coming of the Lord
2. And the glory of the Lord

SECOND LESSON:

Genesis 22: 15-18
By: Ada Nze Mrs Njideka Onuzulike
THEME: BLESSINGS OF ABRAHAM

The angel of the Lord called to Abraham from heaven a second time and said, "I swear by myself, declares the Lord, that because you have done this and have not withheld your son, your only son, I will surely bless you and make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and as the sand on the seashore.

Your descendants will take possession of the cities of their enemies, and through your offspring all nations on earth will be blessed, because you have obeyed me.

The word of the Lord

Choir Presentation:
1. I will give thanks unto thee o Lord
2.Okaka

THIRD LESSON:

Genesis 3:8-16
Mr. Anselm Nnamdi Woko Uzoh (Akpantu)
THEME: THE FALL OF MAN

And they heard the voice of the Lord God walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and then, Adam and his wife Eve hid themselves from the presence of Lord God amongst the trees of the garden. And Lord God called Adam saying to him, "Where are you?" He said, "I heard your voice in the garden and I was afraid because I was naked, so I hid."

God said, "who told you that you were naked? Have you eaten of the tree I ordered you not to eat? The man answered, "The woman you put with me gave me fruit from the tree and I ate."

God said to the woman, "what have you done?" The woman said, "The serpent deceived me and I ate."

The Lord God said to the serpent, "Since you have done that, be cursed among all the cattle and wild beasts! You will crawl on your belly and eat dust all the days of your life. I will make you enemies, you and the woman, your offspring and her offspring. He will crush your head and you will strike his heel.

The word of the Lord.

Choir presentations
1. Jericho wall
2. Uwa Mmehi by Jude Nnam

FOURTH LESSON:

John 1:6-14
By: Mr. Anya Joseph Ndubuisi (Don Joe)
THEME: THE MYSTERY OF INCARNATION

God sent his messenger, a man named John, who came to tell people about the light, so that all should hear the message and believe. He himself was not the light; he came to tell about the light. This was the real light. The light that comes into the world and shines on all people. The word was in the world and though God made the world through him, yet the world did not recognize Him. He came to his own country but his own people did not receive Him, some however did receive him and believe in him, so he gave them the right to become God's children. They did not become God's children by natural means, that is, by being born as the children of a human father; God himself was their father. The word became a human being and full of grace and truth, lived among us, we saw his glory and the glory which he received as the father's only son.

The word of the Lord
Choir Presentation:
1. O thou that tellest good tidings to Zion
2. Obi Dimkpa

FIFTH LESSON:

Matthew 1:18-25
By: Mr. Cyril Amaechi Iweh
THEME: THE NAME OF JESUS

Now the birth of Jesus happened this way after his mother Mary was betrothed to Joseph, before they came together she was found with a child of the Holy Spirit. Then Joseph being a just man and not wanting to make her a public example was minded to put her away secretly. But while he thought of these things, behold an angel of the Lord appeared to him in the dream saying; Joseph son of David, do not be afraid to take Mary to be your wife, for that which is conceived is of the Holy Spirit. And she will bring forth a child and you shall name him Jesus for he will save his people from their sins. So all this was done that it might be fulfilled that which was spoken by the Lord through the prophets. "A virgin will become pregnant and have a son and he will be called Emmanuel, which means "God with us" so when Joseph woke up, he hurried Mary as the angel of the Lord told him but he has no sexual relations with her before she gave birth to her son and Joseph named him Jesus.

The word of the Lord.
Choir Presentation:
1. Christmas Medley
2. Amugoro anyi otu nwa

SIXTH LESSON:

Isaiah 9:2,5-7
By: Barr. KC Okwu
THEME: FOR UNTO US A CHILD IS BORN

You have enlarged the nation; you have increased their joy. They rejoice before you as people rejoice at harvest time as they rejoice in dividing and spoil. For a child is born to us, a son is given to us; the royal ornament is laid upon his shoulder, and his name is proclaimed: